

GETTING CURIOUSER

THE DISH TV saga has a fresh twist. Shareholders have rejected all three proposals presented at the AGM last December. The Essel group-owned DTH major is already thick in a fight with YES Bank, its largest shareholder. Right after Dish TV defaulted on a loan to YES Bank, the issue has come down to when control will shift. It's only a matter of time before something gives.

—KRISHNA GOPALAN

₹1.50

LAKH CRORE

**VALUE OF
SHARES SOLD
BY FIIs IN THE
SECOND HALF
OF 2021-22
TILL MARCH 14,
AGAINST NET
INFLOWS OF
AROUND ₹8,530
CRORE IN THE
FIRST HALF OF
THE SAME
FISCAL**

16 |

ACCEL- ERATING

Accel, one of the oldest venture capital firms in the country, has launched a new \$650-million fund to invest in pre-seed to growth start-ups across India and Southeast Asia. The fund takes the global VC's total commitments in the region to \$2 billion. The firm has backed some of India's most valuable start-ups including Flipkart, Swiggy and Freshworks. The new funding vehicle, its seventh and largest for the region, will give the investor substantial dry powder to write larger cheques and expand portfolio in an increasingly competitive funding environment.

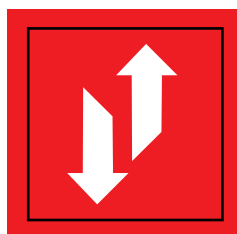
—BINU PAUL



WHERE ARE THE SHOPS?

As Reliance Retail and Amazon grapple for control of the Kishore Biyani-promoted Future Retail, Reliance Retail has now put itself in the driver's seat by taking over 200 Future Group stores after lease payments were not made. There's more. Reliance is licking its chops after termination notices were served for another 835 stores, including Big Bazaar. Amazon has now chosen to release ads saying the actions were done in a clandestine manner by playing a fraud on the constitutional courts in India.

—KRISHNA GOPALAN



A GIFT TO INVESTORS

NSE-owned International Financial Services Centre (IFSC), located in Gujarat's GIFT-City, has launched trading in US stocks from March 3, 2022, specifically, those of Amazon, Apple, Alphabet, Netflix, Tesla, Meta, Walmart, and Microsoft. Eventually this will be increased to 50 stocks. The offering is launched under a regulatory sandbox for nine months. The platform will offer shares in the form of unsponsored depository receipts that track underlying stocks in the US.

—TEENA JAIN KAUSHAL

Metals' Mettle

METAL AND MINING stocks are hogging the limelight in Dalal Street due to the war between Russia and Ukraine. Russia, which produces 6 per cent of the world's aluminium and 10 per cent of its nickel, is a commodity powerhouse and a net exporter in many countries. Any supply-side disruption in Russia will further mount the prices of metals. There are hopes that elevated prices in the global markets will give a push to the near-term earnings of non-ferrous companies. The BSE Metal index (up 11 per cent) has outpaced the benchmark equity index BSE Sensex (down 8 per cent) on a year-to-date basis till March 8.

—RAHUL OBEROI

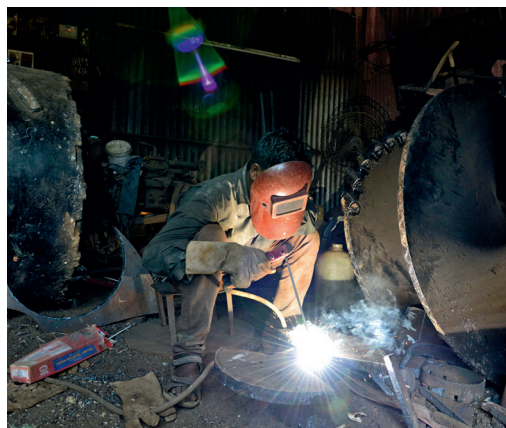


PHOTO BY MANDAR DEODHAR